Naima

Composer: John Coltrane. Ballad. Key center: A flat major. Feel: rubato into a slow 4.

Form: A (8) A (8) B (8) A (8). Pedal Eb under most of the A sections. Let the melody breathe. Do not rush the turns.

A section chord sketch

| Ebsus Bbm7/Eb | Ebsus Bbm7/Eb | AbMaj7/Eb Db/Eb | Ebsus | (repeat)

B section (bridge)

| Bmaj7 G7 | Cmaj7 Ab7 | Bmaj7 G7 | Cmaj7 Bb7sus |

Frank DeLuca margin notes (pencil)

"Jess, the whole tune lives on that Eb pedal. Play the head like you are telling someone something you have only said once before. On the bridge, do not blow through the changes, let Ray set them under you. Breathe at the top of bar 5. Your tone on the low Bb is your father in the room. Save the altissimo for the last A, once, and mean it. We worked this at the lesson on January 14. Play it for Edward on the 11th."

Personal note (J. Webb)

Played this at the Green Note last fall and again every November 11 for Dad. Keep it slow. Frank is right about the low Bb.

Annotated working chart, property of Jessica Webb. Original lead sheet from the Frank DeLuca studio book, marked at the lesson of January 14, 2026.